Riphah School of Computing & Innovation

Final Year Project (FYP) Proposal Evaluation Rubrics

Category: Continuation Project (Existing Product Based Project)

This evaluation rubric is specifically designed for the Continuation Project category based on the FYP Framework v1.0 and aligned with the structural requirements of 'Template03 - Project Proposal & Plan -v1.1'. It explicitly evaluates the unambiguous identification of the prior system's baseline, the exact functional delta of the new contribution, integration methodology, refactoring, and rollback/testing strategies.

Proposal Evaluation Score Summary

1. Comprehensive Score Breakdown (100 Marks)

Evaluation Component & Criteria Description		Marks
Domain A: Written Proposal Document & Baseline Identification (40 Marks)	Criteria 1: Executive Summary & Prior System Baseline	8
	Criteria 2: Problem Statement & Baseline Delta	7
	Criteria 3: Existing System Critique & Competitive Analysis	7
	Criteria 4: Project Scope (In/Out) & Value Proposition	8
	Criteria 5: Project Plan (WBS, Gantt & Roles Matrix)	5
	Criteria 6: Document Structure, Formatting & Citations	5
Domain B: Technical Design, Integration & Methodology (35 Marks)		
	Criteria 7: Proposed Solution & Functional Requirements	
	Criteria 8: System Architectural Integration	6
	Criteria 9: Technical Debt & Refactoring Plan	7
	Criteria 10: Implementation Tools & Tech Stack	5
	Criteria 11: Integration Testing, Risk & Rollback Strategy	5
	Criteria 12: Commercial/Industrial Viability & Impact	7
		5

Domain C: Oral Defense & Presentation (25 Marks)	Criteria 13: Presentation Organization & Visual Clarity	
	Criteria 14: Technical Communication & Delivery	5
	Criteria 15: Q&A Response & Integration Defense	10
		10
TOTAL SCORE		100

2. Detailed 15-Criteria Evaluation Matrix

Domain A: Problem Identification, Background Study & Baseline Definition (40 Marks)

Criteria & Max Marks	Unsatisfactory (0–1):	Developing(2–3)	Proficient / Excellent(4–5):	Marks
1. Executive Summary & Prior System Baseline (10 Marks)	Missing summary. Fails to identify the prior project's name, origin, or current functional state. Codebase access is not confirmed.	Mentions the previous project but lacks an unambiguous description of its current state and known limitations. Handover status is unclear.	Clear executive summary. Provides an unambiguous, evidence-backed description of the prior team's work, explicitly confirms repository/codebase access, and details the current functional state.	10
2. Problem Statement & Baseline Delta (10 Marks)	Fails to differentiate between existing capabilities and new proposed features. No justification for the continuation.	States the problem but the delta between 'existing capability' and 'new capability' is blurry. Weak justification for why the addition is needed.	Makes the exact delta explicit (contrasting existing vs. new). Strong justification for why the new features are required (e.g., user demand, missed scope).	10
3. Existing System features , Gap, Critique & Competitive Analysis (7 Marks)	Minimal background study. Fails to critically evaluate the current system's flaws or analyze market competitors.	Summarizes the existing system but lacks deep critical analysis of its limitations or comparison with similar external products.	Thorough critical synthesis of the current system's limitations, clearly linking them to market needs, accompanied by a strong competitive analysis.	7
4. Project Scope (In-Scope/Out-of-Scope) & Value Proposition (8 Marks)	Scope is unbounded or purely duplicates existing work. No clear value proposition for the new additions.	Scope is defined but boundaries between the original project and new modules are slightly overlapping. Generic value proposition.	Highly precise definition of what the new continuation phase will and will NOT do. Compelling value proposition demonstrating why this extension matters to end-users.	8
5. Project Plan (WBS, Gantt & Roles Matrix) (5 Marks)	No WBS, Roles Matrix, or Gantt chart. Timeline missing.	Basic timeline provided but missing explicit deliverable breakdowns or unclear team responsibilities for integration tasks.	Detailed WBS separating research/refactoring/development phases, clear Roles & Responsibility Matrix, and structured Gantt chart.	5

Domain B: Technical Design, Integration & Methodology (35 Marks)

Criteria & Max Marks	Unsatisfactory (0–1):	Developing(2–3)	Proficient / Excellent(4–5):	Marks
7. Proposed Solution & Functional Requirements (6 Marks)	No clear functional requirements for the new modules. Solution is generically described without user stories.	Lists basic features but lacks standard user stories or clear non-functional requirements (NFRs) for the extension.	Explicitly details new Functional Requirements traceable to user needs, clear User Stories, and NFRs (e.g., performance impact on the existing system).	6
8. System Architectural Integration (7 Marks)	No architecture diagram provided, or treats the project as a from-scratch build ignoring existing components.	Conceptual diagram present, but it is unclear how the new modules safely integrate with the existing database or architecture.	Clear architectural diagram explicitly mapping the existing framework and detailing exactly how new components integrate (e.g., extending without breaking DB schema).	7
9. Technical Debt & Refactoring Plan (5 Marks)	Ignores the quality of the inherited codebase. No mention of technical debt or necessary legacy code updates.	Acknowledges legacy code but provides no actionable plan on how to refactor or clean it before adding new features.	Clearly identifies areas of the existing system requiring refactoring before new features can be safely added. Scopes refactoring work explicitly.	5
10. Implementation Tools & Tech Stack (5 Marks)	Tech stack is unspecified or completely inappropriate for integrating with the existing system.	Technologies listed but lacks justification regarding why they were chosen to interface with the legacy stack.	Well-justified choice of tools, frameworks, and APIs. Explains whether they are migrating the stack or perfectly matching the existing environment.	5
11. Integration Testing, Risk & Rollback Strategy (7 Marks)	No integration testing or rollback plan. Assumes new features won't break the existing deployment.	Lists generic risks. Mentions testing but lacks a concrete plan to protect existing live/pilot data.	Provides a strong integration and regression testing plan. Details a staging/testing environment setup and a concrete rollback strategy to avoid disrupting the current pilot/system.	7
12. Commercial/Industrial Viability & Impact (5 Marks)	Continuation offers no real practical value or industry relevance. Barely a minor patch.	Offers some practical impact, but alignment with organizational/industrial problem solving is weak.	High practical utility. Provides an industry-ready solution that delivers significant business value or solves a clear organizational problem as	5

			per FYP Framework objectives.	

Domain C: Oral Defense & Presentation (25 Marks)

Criteria & Max Marks	Unsatisfactory (0–1):	Developing(2–3)	Proficient / Excellent(4–5):	Marks
13. Presentation Organization & Visual Clarity (5 Marks)	Unstructured, cluttered slides, unreadable text, missing architectural diagrams.	Logical structure but visual aids are standard. Struggles to visually separate old vs. new work on slides.	Exceptionally structured slides with clear layout. Visually distinguishes the inherited baseline from the proposed new contribution perfectly.	5
14. Technical Communication & Delivery (10 Marks)	Reads directly from slides, poor time management, weak grasp of technical vocabulary.	Clear delivery but relies on notes; adequate time management, unbalanced team speaking roles.	Fluent, engaging delivery, precise technical terms, perfect time management, and balanced team participation.	10
15. Q&A Response & Integration Defense (10 Marks)	Unable to answer technical questions; defensive, or shows a lack of understanding of the inherited codebase.	Answers surface questions but struggles to justify integration choices, database extension logic, or refactoring decisions.	Demonstrates deep mastery of both the old system and new proposed architecture. Logically defends integration strategy, tech stack, and risk mitigation against panel scrutiny.	10